

Dubbo Wellington Narromine Trangie Reuse Programs

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Official e-waste, reuse and resale programs — Dubbo, Wellington, Narromine and Trangie

Research date: 2 October 2026 (AEST)

Executive finding

Across Dubbo, Wellington, Narromine and Trangie, the official systems are still much stronger at collecting/recycling e-waste than at testing, wiping, repairing and reselling working electronics.

No current official council program was found that routinely performs this full electronics-reuse workflow:

device arrives → functional test → secure data erase → repair/refurbish → resale/redeployment → recycle only failures

The towns do have different levels of reuse activity, but most reuse is encouraged before the waste facility takes custody.

1. Dubbo

Official e-waste route

Dubbo Regional Council's Whylandra Waste and Recycling Centre accepts separated domestic e-waste and old TVs free from residents.

Council has also said recyclable items including domestic e-waste can be segregated free at Whylandra/Wellington.

Current regional research also identifies Whylandra as a NetWaste e-waste collection point.

Sources:

- Dubbo Regional Council Whylandra page
- <https://www.dubbo.nsw.gov.au/News-and-Media/News-and-Resources/Council-News/2024/waste-facilities-cashless-from-1-july-2024>
- <https://www.netwaste.com.au/ewaste/>

Reuse/resale

Dubbo Regional Council has formally investigated reuse shops.

In October 2024 Council said staff were preparing a business case for:

- one reuse shop at Whylandra Waste Facility;
- one reuse shop associated with Wellington.

Council said the business case would assess environmental, economic and social benefits, followed by community/stakeholder consultation.

Source:

- <https://www.dubbo.nsw.gov.au/News-and-Media/News-and-Resources/Council-News/2024/outcomes-from-the-october-ordinary-council-meeting>

Earlier Council material also said the Whylandra and Wellington master plans included provision for tip/reuse shops and recognised their role in the local circular economy and landfill diversion.

As of this research date, current facility pages did not verify that an electronics-focused reuse shop is operating.

Practical conclusion

Dubbo Council clearly recognises reuse as desirable, but its current public e-waste service remains primarily a collection/recycling pathway.

2. Wellington

Official e-waste route

Wellington Waste Transfer Station accepts segregated domestic e-waste/old TVs under Dubbo Regional Council's waste system.

It is also a listed regional e-waste collection point.

Reuse/resale

Wellington was explicitly included in Dubbo Regional Council's reuse-shop planning.

The 2024 business-case update described:

- Whylandra reuse shop;
- Wellington reuse shop.

Current research did not verify an operating electronics reuse/refurbishment shop in Wellington.

Practical conclusion

Wellington has a full official e-waste route and a planned reuse-shop concept, but no verified current electronics testing/refurbishment/resale system was found.

3. Narromine

Official e-waste route

Narromine Shire Council's 2026-27 fees identify domestic e-waste as no charge at the waste facility.

NetWaste also lists Narromine as an e-waste collection point.

Official reuse activity

Narromine has taken a low-infrastructure reuse approach through programs such as Garage Sale Trail.

Narromine Shire Council's 2024-25 Annual Report records:

- 47 garage sales/stalls promoted through the 2024 Garage Sale Trail;
- 4,231 items reused or sold.

This is important because it achieves reuse without Council needing to:

- take custody;
- test products;
- run a store;
- provide warranties;
- manage unsold stock.

Electronics-specific reuse

No current official Narromine Council program was found that:

- tests computers;
- securely wipes drives;
- refurbishes laptops/phones;
- resells or redistributes them.

Practical conclusion

Narromine promotes reuse, but its model is mainly resident-to-resident reuse, not council-operated electronics refurbishment.

4. Trangie

Official electronics-recycling activity

Current Narromine Shire information identifies small-item recycling through Trangie Library for categories including:

- mobile phones;
- printer cartridges;
- household batteries;
- smoke detectors;
- selected lamps.

For full computers/TVs, Narromine's main waste facility is the more clearly documented e-waste route.

Reuse/resale

No current official Trangie electronics-reuse/refurbishment/resale program was found.

Practical conclusion

Trangie has small-electronics recycling access, but no verified council-run device-rescue operation.

5. Regional downstream context

All four towns sit within or adjacent to the broader NetWaste regional system.

NetWaste currently says Sims Metal Management collects e-waste from the majority of NetWaste councils, but it does not publicly map every member council to Sims.

Other documented regional routes include:

- Parkes → Sircel;
- Mudgee Tip Shop → reuse opportunity before recycling;
- historical NetWaste material → Sims St Marys shredding;
- historical/current Dubbo/Matthews/AMR pathways, with Dubbo's current post-2025 processor still unresolved.

Therefore do not assign a current downstream company to a specific town unless the council/contract identifies it.

See:

- REGIONAL-EWASTE-PATHWAYS.md
- WHAT-HAPPENS-TO-EWASTE.md
- BACKLOG-13-16-REGIONAL-SUPPLY.md

6. Reuse hierarchy actually visible in the region

The current pattern is:

Dubbo/Wellington

Council collection + recycling, with reuse shops planned/business-cased.

Narromine

Council collection + recycling, plus person-to-person reuse via Garage Sale Trail.

Trangie

Small-electronics recycling, but no verified specialist reuse layer.

Parkes

Council collection with Sircel as a documented current regional processor.

Mudgee

Tip Shop gives a clearer example of local reuse before final recycling.

7. What is missing

The missing regional service is not another generic e-waste cage.

It is a specialist layer that can do:

1. provenance/ownership check;
2. serial capture;
3. safe battery inspection;
4. secure data sanitisation;
5. power-on and hardware test;
6. repair/value assessment;
7. refurbishment;

8. commercial resale or social redeployment;
9. donor-parts recovery;
10. verified recycling for failures.

None of the four local council systems was found publicly providing this complete electronics-specific service.

8. Implication for Dubbo eWaste

A regional Dubbo-based operation could potentially serve:

Dubbo + Wellington + Narromine + Trangie

without trying to replace council waste services.

The role would be:

intercept selected reusable electronics before they enter waste contracts

while councils/NetWaste remain the downstream system for material that genuinely cannot be reused.

That model needs:

- direct council permission/partnership before diverting council-owned material;
- written ownership transfer from private/business donors;
- secure data practices;
- strict intake;
- known downstream routes;
- no assumption that public waste facilities will hand over items after disposal.

9. Questions to resolve with each council

Dubbo Regional Council

- Current status of Whylandra and Wellington reuse-shop business cases.
- Is either reuse shop funded, designed or scheduled?
- Would electronics be included?
- Can reusable e-waste be diverted before it becomes council waste?
- Who currently owns e-waste after drop-off?
- Does the current e-waste contract prohibit diversion?
- Could a pilot reuse partner operate by appointment rather than inside the waste facility?

Narromine Shire Council

- Exact current route for computers/TVs after Narromine drop-off.
- Whether any reusable equipment is currently separated.
- Whether Council would support a pre-disposal electronics reuse pilot.
- Whether Garage Sale Trail or community-reuse programs could include secure electronics reuse.
- Whether Trangie residents can take full e-waste locally or must use Narromine for certain categories.

Trangie

- Exact current full e-waste acceptance at the transfer/waste facility.

- Whether laptops/desktops/monitors/TVs are accepted locally.
- Whether a mobile/periodic reuse collection would be useful.

10. Sources

Dubbo/Wellington

- <https://www.dubbo.nsw.gov.au/Households-Residents/Rubbish-Recycling-and-Sustainability/whylandra-waste-recycling-centre>
- <https://www.dubbo.nsw.gov.au/Households-Residents/Rubbish-Recycling-and-Sustainability/wellington-waste-transfer-station>
- <https://www.dubbo.nsw.gov.au/News-and-Media/News-and-Resources/Council-News/2024/waste-facilities-cashless-from-1-july-2024>
- <https://www.dubbo.nsw.gov.au/News-and-Media/News-and-Resources/Council-News/2024/outcomes-from-the-october-ordinary-council-meeting>
- Dubbo Regional Council 2024–25 Budget/Operational Plan submission responses, reuse-shop discussion.

Narromine/Trangie

- <https://www.narromine.nsw.gov.au/residents/waste-disposal-fees>
- <https://www.narromine.nsw.gov.au/residents/excluded-waste>
- Narromine Shire Council 2024–25 Annual Report — Garage Sale Trail result: 47 sales/stalls, 4,231 items reused/sold.

Regional

- <https://www.netwaste.com.au/ewaste/>
- <https://www.netwaste.com.au/about-us/>
- REGIONAL-EWASTE-PATHWAYS.md